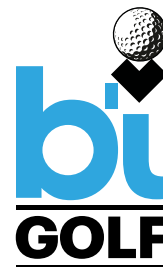




AUGUSTA NATIONAL, AUGUSTA, GEORGIA, US

Augusta National is the Mecca for golf lovers. Host to the annual Masters Tournament, it is arguably one of the most famous courses in the world. However, it is strictly members-only, so the only way you can play there is if you become a member or accompany one. While the membership rolls are not public, it is believed the club has around 300 members. So put on your best smile and cultivate a member. May the course be with you!



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ST ANDREWS LINKS, SCOTLAND



Known as the birthplace of golf, St Andrews Links in Scotland has seven courses of which the Old Course, built sometime in the 15th century, is considered the most ancient. Little wonder, it is on every golf-lover's bucket list. But here's the good news—it is a public course and remains open to all, provided you have a handicap of 36 or less. That, of course, also means that you need to book a tee time a year in advance. Applications open in August for tee times for the following year (April-October) and it costs £270-295 (₹28,000-₹30,500) for a round of golf. However, winter packages between November and March are cheaper, around £160 (₹16,500). Applications are open from June to play in the winters. And in case you decide to try your luck on an unplanned trip to Scotland, the Old Course offers a number of tee times as a lottery, which is drawn two days prior to the date of play.

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